

Microsoft 365 Copilot Analytics

Multi-Agency Setup Guide

Step-by-step implementation for multi-agency Copilot Analytics in a shared M365 tenant

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How This Document Fits

This is a **Setup** guide. It provides the hands-on configuration steps for deploying Copilot Analytics across multiple agencies in a shared M365 tenant. You should have already chosen your architecture before arriving here.

Section	Purpose	Who Reads
Strategy	Decide what to implement	CIO, SA, Business Leaders
Setup (you are here)	Configure and deploy	IT Admin, Insights Admin
Operate	Use dashboards and reports daily	Leaders, Analysts, Managers
Reference	Look up details and fix issues	Everyone (as needed)

Read the Decision Guide First

Read the Multi-Agency Reporting Pattern Decision Guide first to choose between **Default Priority** and **Restricted Reporting**. These are this guide's author-created patterns, not Microsoft product or security architectures. This setup guide assumes you have documented the decision and accepted the residual risks. Jump to the section that matches your choice:

- Section 1 — Default Priority Pattern Setup (2–4 hours)
- Section 2 — Restricted Reporting Pattern Setup (1–3 days; legacy anchor retained)

THIS GUIDE'S AUTHOR-CREATED ARCHITECTURE PATTERNS

Default Priority and **Restricted Reporting** (formerly labelled "Isolation" in this guide and retained in existing URLs) are editorial names created by this guide. They are **not** Microsoft product, security, compliance, sovereignty, or licensing terms. Microsoft Learn documents the component capabilities; it does not document this guide's combined pattern as an end-to-end security boundary.

Table of Contents

1. Control Boundary and Go-Live Gates
2. Default Priority Pattern Setup
3. Restricted Reporting Pattern Setup
4. Ongoing Governance
5. CSV Templates
6. What to Read Next

0. Control Boundary and Go-Live Gates

Viva Insights partitions are controls for **analyst query workspaces**: they determine the rows and columns available to an assigned analyst in a partition. They do not, by themselves, govern the Copilot Dashboard, Analytics Reports, Agent Dashboard, metrics export, delegation, manager access, privileged roles, the global partition, downloaded results, or Power BI. Restricted Reporting is therefore a **defense-in-depth reporting-segmentation pattern**, not cryptographic, tenant, product-security, or certified compliance isolation. See Partitions in Viva Insights (last updated 23 June 2025).

Surface-by-Actor Boundary Matrix

Actor / surface	Primary control
Agency leader or manager — Copilot Dashboard and Analytics Reports	Access list, hierarchy-derived scope, AutoCxO
Delegate — Dashboard, Agent Dashboard, and Copilot insights	Delegation eligibility, delegator scope, and dele
Agency analyst — advanced query workspace	Insights Analyst role plus agency partition assign
Global Administrator, globally assigned user, or global-partition analyst	Least-privilege role and assignment governanc
Leader or analyst — Agent Dashboard and metrics export	Separate feature/access policy and product eli
Report viewer or workspace role — Power BI	Dedicated workspace/app audience, Viewer ro

Supported Environment and Licensing Gate

Do Not Proceed on Plan-Level Assumptions

Availability is feature- and cloud-specific. Supported Microsoft 365 environments for Viva Insights features (30 June 2026) says GCC does not support Agent Dashboard, Copilot metrics export, or Copilot Power BI reports. Connect to the Agent Dashboard (30 July 2026) says Agent Dashboard is unavailable in national and regional clouds. Base plan support in Environment requirements for Viva Insights (12 May 2026) does not establish feature parity. Record the exact cloud and verify every required surface in the tenant UI and Message Center before design.

For advanced access, Microsoft pages describe the threshold differently. The environment article explicitly gives **30 Microsoft 365 Copilot + 20 Viva Insights** as 50 assigned Viva Insights service plans; the Dashboard article describes 50 Copilot or 50 Viva Insights. Do **not** state that mixed licence assignments fail. Verify assigned service plans, feature presence, and processing state. For Agent Dashboard, use the conservative feature-specific prerequisite of **50 Microsoft Copilot licences plus agent activity**; a 50-Viva-Insights-only tenant must validate availability. Escalate a documented mismatch to Microsoft Support.

Organizational Data Source and Precedence Gate

Record Attribute Ownership Before Upload

Do not describe an upload as universally or permanently replacing Entra. Uploaded data changes the source for supplied dashboard attributes; parallel ingestion can keep or restore Entra for `ManagerId` and `Organization` ; Microsoft 365 Profile precedence is separate. Before change, record each required attribute, current source, owner, effective date, coverage, and target surface in Data Quality and Profile. Check **Setup → Migration and imports**, Message Center, and the actual tenant UI. Use Organizational Data in Microsoft 365 for new or edited uploads unless the tenant explicitly exposes a supported legacy path; use documented update/delete behavior, never a dummy-row workaround.

Source basis: Use your organizational data in Microsoft 365 and Microsoft Viva (2 December 2025); Upload and maintain data through the Microsoft 365 admin center (13 August 2026); Use Microsoft Entra plus .csv files for parallel data uploads (30 June 2025); and Import and manage your organizational data with a .csv file (29 July 2026). Workday import has a documented 100,000-user limit (Import organizational data from Workday, 6 April 2026), and API-based import remains preview (Import organizational data using API-based import (preview), 6 April 2026).

Change Control, Negative Tests, and Evidence

1. **Before change:** export or capture VFAM policies, access lists, role assignments, delegations, manager hierarchy, partition filters and analysts, org-data source/quality, query assets, and Power BI workspace/app/RLS/export settings. Define owner, maintenance window, approvers, success/failure criteria, and restoration sequence.

2. **Test cohort first:** use representative agency, shared-services, cross-agency, and privileged accounts. Treat enabling partitions as a high-impact tenant change; turning partitions off requires Microsoft Support. Export query assets before enabling, and confirm deletion impact before removing a partition.
3. **Mandatory actors:** agency leader, cross-agency manager, shared executive, delegate, agency analyst, multi-partition analyst, global-partition analyst, report Viewer, Power BI Member/Contributor, AI Administrator, Insights Administrator, Insights Analyst, and Global Administrator.
4. **Mandatory surfaces:** Copilot Dashboard, Analytics Reports, Agent Dashboard, weekly/daily metrics export, advanced query workspace, query-result download, delegation, manager-published reports, Power BI workspace/app, report export, Analyze in Excel, subscriptions, and resharing.
5. **Evidence:** capture test date, tester identity/role, group/partition membership, policy export, org-data snapshot, expected denial or allowed result, observed result, screenshot/audit record, Power BI permissions, owner, and remediation ticket.
6. **Publication and go-live veto:** any failed or unexecutable negative test blocks publication and production rollout. Roll back the change or remove access, preserve evidence, and open Microsoft Support when documented and observed behavior differ.
7. **Approval:** obtain written Security, Compliance/Legal, Privacy/DPO, Viva Insights owner, and Power BI owner sign-off on tested behavior and residual risks. Product documentation is not a compliance attestation.
8. **Retest:** run the full suite quarterly and after any role, hierarchy, delegation, org-data, partition, VFAM, licence, cloud, preview-status, or Power BI sharing change.

1. Default Priority Pattern Setup

Estimated time: 2–4 hours | **PowerShell required:** No

This author-created pattern relies on native Copilot Dashboard scoping (“Your group”) driven by Entra ID manager hierarchy. An agency CEO can receive that scope **only when access, tenant, and reporting-line conditions are met** (see callout below). Cross-agency and tenant-wide visibility from other access sources is explicitly accepted in this model.

Automatic Access Has Hard Prerequisites

Per Microsoft Learn, *automatic* dashboard access for senior leaders is granted **only** when both tenant criteria are met:

- The tenant has **at least 2,500 users** with an Entra ID; *and*
- The **majority of users share a single reporting line** (e.g., report up to the same CEO).

Within a qualifying tenant, a leader is auto-identified only if they are in the **top three levels** with a significant portion of the org reporting to them. A separate agency’s top leader is auto-identified **only if that agency’s hierarchy tree is at least 4% of the overall company size**. Consequences for multi-agency tenants:

- **Tenant under 2,500 users** → *no* agency CEO gets automatic access. Use manual access grants + delegation (Phase 2).
- **Small agency (<4% of the tenant)** → its CEO is not auto-identified, even in a large tenant. Grant access manually.

The “Your group” scope still works once access is granted manually — these gates govern *automatic* identification only. Access is re-evaluated weekly.

Phase 0: Base Setup

Complete **all five steps in this guide’s implementation framework** in the Admin Setup Guide before proceeding. The five-step sequence is an author-created implementation aid, not Microsoft’s capability taxonomy. This establishes:

- Copilot and Viva Insights service-plan assignment using the conflict-safe licensing wording in Section 0; Agent Dashboard has a separate conservative preview prerequisite
- Insights Admin and Insights Analyst roles
- VFAM feature access policies (dashboard, advanced analytics, behavioural experiences)
- Org data upload (Entra connection or CSV)
- Default partition with analyst assignment

Verify Before Continuing

Run through the Global Admin Readiness Checklist in the Admin Setup Guide. All 8 checks must pass before you proceed to Phase 1.

Phase 1: Verify AutoCxO and Delegation

Step	Action	Where
1.1	Confirm Auto CxO Identification is on	On by default — there is no web-app “General” toggle
1.2	Confirm delegation is available	No admin “enable” step exists. Delegation is self-service
1.3	Verify each agency CEO gets automatic “Your group” scope	Ask each agency CEO to open the Copilot Dashboard

If a CEO Doesn’t See “Your Group”

Check these causes in order:

1. **Automatic-access prerequisites not met** — tenant under 2,500 users, no single majority reporting line, or the agency tree is under 4% of the tenant (see the warning at the top of this section). In these cases the CEO is never auto-identified; grant access manually and use delegation.
2. **Incorrect or missing ManagerId data in Entra ID** — verify the CEO’s reporting chain: every employee in the agency must have a valid manager chain that terminates at the agency CEO. See the Data Onboarding Guide for manager hierarchy verification steps.
3. **Licence or processing delay** — data processing can take up to seven days after licences are assigned, and access is re-evaluated weekly.

Phase 2: Grant Additional Access

Step	Action	Where
2.1	Delegate to agency CIOs / senior leaders	Each agency CEO uses the Delegation feature (Copilot Dashboard →
2.2	Grant Central IT “Your company” scope	A senior leader who already holds “ Your company ” scope delegates

Phase 2.3: Enrich Org Data (Optional)

If the Entra ID connection provides sufficient attributes (`ManagerId` , `Organization`), no additional data upload is needed. If you require custom attributes (e.g., `Agency` , `FunctionType` , `CostCentre`), upload a CSV supplement:

1. Enable the Entra connection for `ManagerId` + `Organization` attributes (if not already done in Phase 0).
2. If custom attributes are needed, prepare a CSV file following the CSV Templates (Section 4).
3. Upload via the steps in the Data Onboarding Guide.

Phase 3: Create Partitions (Optional)

Partitions are **optional** in the Default Priority pattern. Use them when you want the rows and columns available in an analyst query workspace scoped to an agency; they do not scope the other surfaces listed in the boundary matrix.

1. Navigate to **Viva Insights web app** → **Admin** → **Privacy settings** → **Partitions**.
2. Click **New partition**.
3. Name the partition after the agency (e.g., "Agency A").
4. Set the filter to the relevant attribute (e.g., `Organization = "Agency A"` or `Agency = "Agency A"`).
5. Assign the partition's analyst(s).
6. Repeat for each agency.

Phase 4: Power BI Reports (Optional)

For deeper analysis beyond the native dashboard, analysts can create Power BI reports from partition-scoped queries.

1. The assigned analyst opens their partition in the Viva Insights web app.
2. Creates a Copilot person query (or uses a pre-built template).
3. Connects the query output to Power BI Desktop.
4. Publishes the report to a **Power BI workspace** dedicated to the agency.
5. Shares the workspace with agency leadership.

For step-by-step guidance on publishing to the Power BI service and assigning stakeholders by **workspace role** (Viewer, Member, etc.) — plus the per-viewer licensing implications — see Analyst Playbook — Share via Power BI (§7.2).

Default Priority Setup Complete

Configuration is complete only after the expected leader and delegate scopes, optional analyst query workspaces, and Power BI permissions pass the negative-test and evidence gate in Section O. Continue to Ongoing Governance.

2. Restricted Reporting Pattern Setup

Estimated time: 1–3 days | **PowerShell required:** Yes (group-scoped VFAM restrictions; partitions are created via the Viva Insights web app UI)

This author-created pattern combines group-scoped dashboard restrictions, partition-scoped analyst query workspaces, controlled privileged access, and dedicated Power BI delivery. A partition limits rows and columns in its assigned analyst workspace; it does not guarantee what that person can access through Dashboard, Agent, export, delegation, manager, global, administrative, downloaded-result, or Power BI surfaces. The design is defense in depth and reporting segmentation, not tenant or security isolation.

Phase 0: Prerequisites

Complete through **Tier 2, Step 3** in the Admin Setup Guide. This establishes:

- Copilot and Viva Insights service-plan assignment using the conflict-safe licensing wording in Section 0
- Insights Admin and Insights Analyst roles
- VFAM verification that the dashboard toggle and Advanced Analytics toggle are accessible

Do NOT Enable Broad Access

Stop after verifying VFAM in Tier 2, Step 3. Do **not** enable AutoCxO, delegation, or broad dashboard access for “Everyone”. Restricted Reporting applies group-scoped controls in Phase 1 and then verifies each surface independently.

Phase 1: Group-Scoped VFAM Restrictions

Target direct Viva Insights web-app and Copilot Dashboard access to the approved Central IT population, while agency leaders receive reports through separately governed Power BI delivery. This is one layer of the pattern and must be tested alongside all other surfaces.

The Copilot Dashboard access control has been removed — re-validate this phase

Microsoft now states that the previous controls for managing dashboard access — the **Copilot Dashboard** control in the Microsoft 365 admin center *and* the equivalent PowerShell policy — are **no longer available**. Access is managed through the **Viva Insights web app** control instead, and policies previously created against the old control now apply to the entire web app.

Why this matters for this pattern: disabling the web-app control removes the targeted user’s access to the **Copilot Dashboard, Copilot Analytics reports, and advanced analysis and admin tools together**. Because the Agent Dashboard is enabled as part of the Viva Insights web app, it is lost as well. There is no documented way to remove only the Copilot Dashboard while leaving the rest of the web app available. Any negative test recorded against the old control is no longer evidence; re-run it against the current control before relying on the result.

Microsoft also notes this settings experience is **rolling out gradually** to customers with more than 50 assigned Copilot licences, so the label and behaviour in a given tenant may lag the documentation. Confirm the actual tenant label and effective policy before relying on it.

The Agent Dashboard has its own separate control (`FeatureId : AgentDashboard`). Both the Viva Insights web app control and the Agent Dashboard control must be enabled for a user to reach it, so an agency lockdown must account for both rather than assuming the web-app control alone is sufficient.

Source: Manage settings for the Microsoft Copilot Dashboard, Agent Dashboard, and Viva Insights web app (13 August 2026).

Step	Action	Details
1.1	Disable Auto CxO Identification	PowerShell only — there is no web-app “General” toggle (see this link) <code>Add-VivaModuleFeaturePolicy -ModuleId VivaInsights -FeatureId AutoCxOIdentification -PolicyState Disabled</code> This control is tenant-level only — it cannot be scoped to an agency
1.2	Disable Delegation	PowerShell only — there is no admin enable/disable toggle in the admin center <code>Add-VivaModuleFeaturePolicy -ModuleId VivaInsights -FeatureId Delegation -PolicyState Disabled</code> Scope the policy to the agency group so non-agency executive users are not affected
1.3	Restrict admin-center access list to Central IT	Microsoft 365 admin center → Settings → Microsoft Viva → Viva Insights → Access → Admin Center → Access List → Central IT
1.4	Create Entra security group	Create a group named <code>AgencyUsers-NoDashboard</code> in Entra ID. See this link for details.
1.5	Apply group-scoped VFAM policy	Run the PowerShell command below to disable the entire Viva Insights web app for the agency group

PowerShell: Disable the Viva Insights Web App for Non-Central-IT Users

Run this in an elevated PowerShell session with ExchangeOnlineManagement module 3.5.1 or later installed (required for non-mail-enabled group support):

```
Add-VivaModuleFeaturePolicy `
-ModuleId VivaInsights `
-FeatureId VivaInsightsWebApp `
-Name DisableForNonCentralIT `
-IsFeatureEnabled $false `
-GroupIds "group-id-here")
```

Replace group-id-here with the Object ID of the AgencyUsers-NoDashboard Entra security group. Changes take effect within 24 hours.

Note: The deprecated -FeatureId CopilotDashboard command no longer applies a policy — the feature was removed when access management moved to the Viva Insights web app toggle.

Why Group-Scoped — Not “Everyone”

Use **group-scoped policies**, not “Everyone”. A blanket “Everyone” disable would also block Central IT and non-agency executives who may legitimately need dashboard access. The group-scoped approach protects these users while locking out agency-level browsing. Because the VivaInsightsWebApp toggle disables the entire web app for the scoped users (Copilot Dashboard, Copilot Analytics reports, Agent Dashboard, and advanced analysis and admin tools), confirm your Central IT analysts and any executives who need direct dashboard access are explicitly added to the access list in Step 1.3 before applying this policy.

Phase 2: Data Strategy

Choose your data path based on whether your agencies have distinct email domains or you need a custom attribute for agency identification.

Choose Your Path

Criterion	Path A — CSV with Agency Attribute
When to use	Agencies share a common email domain, or you need custom grouping that doesn’t align with email do
Data upload	CSV with Agency attribute (see Section 4)
Partition filter	Filter by Agency attribute
Maintenance	Re-upload CSV monthly or on org change

Path A: CSV with Agency Attribute

1. Prepare a CSV file with the following columns (see Section 4 for a template):
 - Microsoft_PersonEmail (required)
 - Microsoft_ManagerEmail (required)
 - Microsoft_Organization (required)
 - EffectiveDate (required)
 - Agency (custom attribute — this is the partition filter)
2. Follow the upload steps in the Data Onboarding Guide.
3. After upload, verify the Agency attribute appears in Viva Insights → Admin → Data quality.

Path B: Entra Domain Filter (Zero CSV)

1. No data upload is required.
2. Verify each agency has a distinct email domain in Entra ID (e.g., @agencyA.gov , @agencyB.gov).
3. The Domain attribute is system-generated from user email addresses and is automatically available for partition filtering.

Phase 3: Create Partitions

Create one partition per agency. Optionally, create a global partition for CIO-level cross-agency reporting.

Step	Action	Details
3.1	Navigate to partitions	Viva Insights web app → Admin → Privacy settings → Partitions
3.2	Create agency partition	Click New partition . Name it after the agency (e.g., "Agency A"). Set the filter: • Path A: Agency = "Agency A" • Path B: Domain = "agencyA.gov"
3.3	Assign analyst(s)	Assign the per-agency analyst to the partition. In that partition's analyst quer
3.4	Repeat for each agency	Create separate partitions for Agency B, Agency C, etc., each with its own filter
3.5	Create global partition (optional)	For CIO-level reporting, create a partition with no filter (includes all users). As

Phase 4: Report Delivery

In Restricted Reporting, the recommended agency-facing delivery path uses **Power BI workspaces/apps** rather than direct Copilot Dashboard access. Power BI permissions are a separate control plane and require their own least-privilege design and negative tests.

1. Each per-agency analyst opens their partition in the Viva Insights web app.
2. Creates a Copilot person query (or uses a pre-built template such as the M365 Copilot Adoption report).
3. Connects the query output to Power BI Desktop.
4. Publishes the report to a **dedicated Power BI workspace** for the agency (e.g., "Agency A — Copilot Analytics").
5. Shares the workspace with agency leadership (CEO, CIO, designated leaders).
6. Repeat for each agency.

For the detailed publish-and-assign steps (Power BI service, workspace roles such as Viewer, Entra-group access, and per-viewer Pro/PPU/Premium licensing), see Analyst Playbook — Share via Power BI (§7.2).

WARNING: Manager Publishing Can Broaden Access

"**Publish Reports**" with a manager hierarchy filter can make enabled managers eligible for additional Viva Insights experiences. A shared executive or cross-agency manager hierarchy may span agencies. Use dedicated **Power BI workspaces/apps** as the primary agency delivery path and test manager publishing, Dashboard scope, export, and delegation before any exception.

Restricted Reporting Configuration Complete

Configuration is not approved for publication or go-live until every required actor and surface passes the negative-test suite, evidence is retained, residual risks are signed off, and rollback is ready. Continue to Ongoing Governance.

3. Ongoing Governance

Multi-agency configurations require ongoing attention. Use the table below as a maintenance schedule.

Frequency	Task	Architecture	D
Monthly	Refresh org data	Both (Path A only for Restricted Reporting)	R
Monthly	Verify partition filters	Both (if using partitions)	S
Monthly	Spot-check dashboard scope	Default Priority	H
Quarterly	Audit delegation list	Default Priority	T
Quarterly	Repeat full boundary test and access recertification	Restricted Reporting	R
Quarterly	Review access logs in Purview	Both	C
On org change	Update partitions	Both (if using partitions)	L
On org change	Update CSV	Path A (Restricted Reporting)	R

4. CSV Templates

Path A: CSV with Agency Attribute

Use this format when agencies share a common email domain and you need a custom `Agency` attribute for partition filtering.

```
Microsoft_PersonEmail,Microsoft_ManagerEmail,Microsoft_Organization,EffectiveDate,Agency,FunctionType
alice@contoso.gov,bob@contoso.gov,Finance,2026-04-01,Agency A,Corporate
bob@contoso.gov,carol@contoso.gov,Finance,2026-04-01,Agency A,Leadership
dave@contoso.gov,eve@contoso.gov,Engineering,2026-04-01,Agency B,Technical
eve@contoso.gov,frank@contoso.gov,Engineering,2026-04-01,Agency B,Leadership
grace@contoso.gov,frank@contoso.gov,Operations,2026-04-01,Agency C,Operations
```

Column	Required	Description
Microsoft_PersonEmail	Yes	Employee’s primary email address (must match Entra ID UPN)
Microsoft_ManagerEmail	Yes	Direct manager’s email address (builds the reporting chain)
Microsoft_Organization	Yes	Department or business unit name
EffectiveDate	Yes	Date the record takes effect (ISO 8601: <code>YYYY-MM-DD</code>)
Agency	Custom	Agency identifier used as partition filter
FunctionType	Custom	Optional — functional classification for deeper analysis

Path B: Entra Domain Filter (Zero CSV)

No CSV is needed. The `Domain` attribute is automatically derived from each user’s email address in Entra ID. Ensure each agency uses a distinct email domain:

Agency	Email Domain	Partition Filter
Agency A	@agencyA.gov	Domain = "agencyA.gov"
Agency B	@agencyB.gov	Domain = "agencyB.gov"
Agency C	@agencyC.gov	Domain = "agencyC.gov"

5. What to Read Next

Document	When to Read
Multi-Agency Reporting Pattern Decision Guide	If you haven't yet chosen between Default Priority and Restricted Reporting
Data Onboarding Guide	Detailed steps for CSV upload, Entra connection, attribute mapping
Admin Setup Guide	Complete all five steps in this guide's author-created implementation
Dashboard Guide	Understanding each dashboard page, metrics, and how to interpret

Source and status notice: Last validated 19 August 2026 against the dated Microsoft Learn sources linked next to each material claim, including Dashboard (18 August 2026), Agent Dashboard preview (30 July 2026), environment requirements (12 May 2026), supported environments (30 June 2026), dashboard settings (13 August 2026), roles (7 July 2026), delegation (9 February 2026), manager settings (23 July 2026), partitions (23 June 2025), privacy settings (20 November 2025), technical privacy (10 December 2025), and organizational-data sources (30 June 2025–13 August 2026). This independent guide's named patterns are not Microsoft product or security terms. Verify current Learn, Message Center, Service Health, tenant UI, and Microsoft Support guidance before implementation.